



MONTHLY UPDATE

Tunisia: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-26 · 37 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA

Summary of the month

On 1 July digital identity stopped being optional for two classes of user, and on 20 July the five-year plan that carries the state's digital programme was promulgated. Between those dates the health ministry disclosed what its new national identifier actually is and what it is bound to, three registers went live or online, and the regulator's own survey found Tunisians using artificial-intelligence tools at nearly twice the rate they use the state's online services.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Policy movement in the window was a meeting rather than an instrument. The head of government [chaired a ministerial council devoted to digitalisation, stating that it is a necessity rather than a choice](#). The council's decisions are not itemised in the record held, so what the base can carry is the fact that it met and the framing it used.

Legislation and regulation

The [Development Plan 2026-2030 was promulgated on 20 July 2026](#) by a single-article law, after adoption by the Assembly on 10 July and by the Council of Regions and Districts on 17 July, and is the binding reference for public policy to 2030. Its [three annex volumes are now held](#): the sectoral volume mentions digital or digitalisation 414 times, artificial intelligence 119, data 72 and cybersecurity 9, makes the digital economy a pillar of human-capital development, and commits to integration into the global digital landscape while preserving digital sovereignty. Every volume held is marked draft, no as-enacted printing has appeared, and whether the promulgated annex differs from the version voted is not established.

Data protection

No legal basis is held for the linked national health dataset — no decree, ministerial order or data-sharing instrument stating the basis, retention rule and supervisory authority for a dataset joining health, civil-status, social-affairs and education records. The [ministry asserts only that the data is stored confidentially and securely](#). An assurance about storage is not an authority to link.

Regional collaboration

Tunisia took a [2027-2030 seat on the African Telecommunications Union's administrative council on 24 July 2026](#), giving it a vote on continental direction across digital transformation, artificial intelligence and cybersecurity. What it intends to press for is not reported.

A [Japanese-financed triangular programme was signed](#), reported 28 July 2026, to run 2026-2028 with the communication technologies ministry and the national technopark operator, convening African participants in Tunis on how startup support systems are built and run; the first session in December 2026 takes eight countries. No amount is disclosed.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

A restricted ministerial council on [4 August 2026 set the orientations of the 2027 draft budget](#) and named accelerating the digital transition as a structuring axis, alongside investment, formalisation of the informal sector, tax equity and renewable energy. No allocation, target or named programme is attached to the digital line, so nothing here establishes what the state intends to spend on it.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

A measurement study of North African 5G published on [3 August 2026](#), cited rather than absorbed, reports the Tunisian 5G median down 30% from launch by month six and the combined 4G and 5G median below the pre-launch baseline, while fixed-wireless lines rose to 319,554 by May 2026 under the regulator's 30 Mbps obligation. Nothing published bears on the submarine cables, data centres or satellite licensing.

The one physical build to move was a stalled one. The grands projets commission [ordered immediate procurement to complete the Cite Numerique d'Ennahli technology park](#) at a review session chaired by the Prime Minister on 10 August, alongside unrelated power-station and hospital projects. No cost, completion date, occupancy plan or account of why the park was incomplete is stated.

Cybersecurity

The national cybersecurity agency [warned on 30 July 2026 of an SMS phishing campaign](#) built on fake unpaid-traffic-fine notices sent from foreign numbers, carrying links to counterfeit platforms that harvest banking and personal data. Its advice was to distrust unsolicited messages, and its offered test was that Tunisian government sites use only the national domain. The lure borrows the credibility of the state's own digitised payment channels; the response on record carries no takedown power and names no data-protection authority. A [second alert on 14 August](#) warned of a surge in social-media account takeovers worked through SMS and email verification-code social engineering.

The scale behind the alerts was published on 7 August: [57,430 cyberattacks recorded in the first half of 2025, and ransomware cases up 140% to 37,076 in 2024](#), on interior ministry and agency figures, as the government finalised a National Cybersecurity Strategy 2026-2030 aimed at critical-infrastructure resilience and skills. The two figures cover different periods and are not a series; no definition of a recorded attack and no incident-reporting obligation behind the count is stated.

DPI

Data Exchange

The customs estate opened a build rather than a service. The customs administration [began the execution phase of an integrated electronic rules-of-origin system financed by a bilateral partner, with technical preparation running to 18 September 2026](#). The dated stage is the preparation, not the go-live: no operating date, trader-facing interface or cost is published.

Digital Identity and CRVS

From 1 July 2026 the mobile identity became a condition of transacting with the state: the [investment authority made it mandatory for all investment-project declarations](#).

The health identifier's provenance became public on [27 July 2026](#). A ministry adviser confirmed that the identifier built for Covid-19 vaccination, holding records of over 3 million childhood immunisations, was adopted as the national health identifier and bound to the national identity card, the social security number and school and university identifiers. [Roughly 100,000 medical files had been linked](#). On protection of that linked dataset the ministry asserts only that data is stored confidentially and securely.

A second identifier moved a step behind it. At a ministerial session at La Kasbah on 18 August the government decided to [upgrade the social identifier system, digitise social-security cards and services and put interconnected systems in place for real-time data exchange between the social funds, health structures and insured persons](#), with drafting of the reform texts to begin immediately. The communique states no timetable, no legal basis for the identifier and no scope.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Tunisia's payments market is large enough for the question of who bears a loss to matter, and the law does not answer it. A published legal analysis finds [no Tunisian text — not the 2000 electronic commerce law, the 2023 cybersecurity decree-law, nor the central bank's 2024 circular — allocating the loss between bank, merchant and cardholder when an electronic payment is hijacked, altered or blocked by a cyber incident](#), against 164.8 million transactions worth 29.5bn dinars in 2025, up 12.3%, and reported cyber incidents rising from 63,000 in 2021 to more than 155,000 in 2022. The absence is now recorded as a gap.

The month's other payments item was an outage notice rather than a policy: the interbank switch [announced a planned technical intervention overnight on 11 August](#), which is the only public statement the base holds about the availability of the rail those 164.8 million transactions run on.

Registries

The [business register went fully digital with access requiring a digital identity](#) for individuals, companies and regulated professions, paper filing discontinued and electronic documents given the same legal value as paper, from 1 July 2026.

At one hospital a first national births-declaration platform had registered 202 births as at 27 July 2026, assigning an identifier automatically at birth and wiring it into civil-status registers and social-affairs platforms.

Sectoral management information systems

Six days before the health identifier's provenance became public, the ministry had said the [Sahetna.tn portal's technical validation and cybersecurity audit were complete](#), the audit reviewed at a steering committee on 10 June.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Two more registers moved. The employment ministry [launched the national register of community companies on 20 July 2026](#), and the launch figures were the disclosure: 230 companies created, 15,000 participants, but only 60 operational and 380 jobs. On [4 August the tax directorate put business tax registration online](#), ending the required visit to a tax office; it was announced by video capsule rather than by gazette, and its confidentiality assurance names no instrument and no supervisory authority.

A restricted ministerial council of 16 August put a count on the rest: [114 projects in execution, some reported above 90% complete](#), covering remote residence certificates, driving-licence renewal, remote passport and identity-card applications, the national health identifier and the customs and health-insurance systems. It is not the same measure as the 192 projects the February council tracked, and the two should not be read as a fall. The council also announced [the imminent launch of a Khadamet mobile application offering more than 40 administrative services, reached through the national digital identity and paid by card or virtual wallet](#). No launch date was given, and the application sits on top of the existing administrative portal of the same name rather than replacing it.

Technology

AI

The period's artificial-intelligence document came from outside the state. A diaspora alumni association [presented a Livre Blanc at the Tunisia Global Forum on 21-22 July](#) and its contents were [reported on 5 August 2026](#): a 2030 vision of a country able to create, adopt and deploy trustworthy artificial intelligence, against a stated baseline of 12.7% adoption at end-2025 and 4,120 developers per million inhabitants. It [names the constraints as the absence of large-scale data centres and sovereign compute, brain drain, and small firms that are 90% of the economic fabric](#), and prescribes frugal compute investment sized by measured demand. The document is declared open source and is not posted anywhere reachable, so all of that is held at press-summary precision.

The state's own document surfaced at the end of the window and settles a gap this ledger has carried. At a restricted ministerial council on 16 August the communication technologies minister [set out the main lines of a National Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2026-2030](#). That establishes the instrument exists and is dated; it does not publish it. No adopted text, cabinet decision, budget or roadmap accompanies the presentation, so the strategy moves from *not held* to in development and no further.

Innovation ecosystem

Tunisia's own startup law, meanwhile, [became the curriculum of the Japanese-financed programme](#) — a statute circulated as a model for other states rather than administered as one country's law.

Capacity

Training and skills

The family and women's ministry, a national entrepreneurs' organisation and a UN regional commission [opened a training programme for 100 women entrepreneurs in e-commerce and artificial-intelligence applications, alongside a national platform for marketing women's products](#). Both sit under a declaration on women, youth, digitalisation and African economic integration whose action plan targets training 100,000 women and young people in e-commerce, AI and cross-border digital payments by 2028, and a US\$50m fund for inclusive markets by the same date. The training launch's own date is not established in the source.

Inclusion

Access to services

On the cost side, the regulator [reported on 18 July 2026](#) that Tunisia's digital basket costs 1.53% of gross national income per head, about US\$5.31 a month — second in the Maghreb and under the two-percent international threshold. The figures are the international union's, cited rather than absorbed as country state.

Data

National statistics

The regulator's observatory [published its 2026 survey on 27 July](#): 85.9% internet use, 84.3% smartphone ownership against 41% for computers, and a ladder that puts [artificial-intelligence applications at 47.9% of internet users and online public administration last at 26.5%](#). Its sampling frame, size and field dates are not stated in the reporting held.

Open data

An agrifood sector data portal [launched on 23 July 2026](#), free after registration, run jointly by three public bodies and built inside a German- and EU-financed project. No amount is disclosed, and nothing is said about what happens to it when the project ends.

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.